DO YOU KNOW?

Adiposity rebound is a phenomenon of normal growth, occurring at approximately 6 years of age which is when a child's body fat increases.

Protein

Girls require more protein than boys because they are reaching menarche. The protein requirements are slightly higher for girls than boys between 10-12 years.

Minerals

Calcium requirements are more to meet the need for skeletal development. They need to take 2-3 glasses of milk. Iron requirement is further increased by rise in the haemoglobin concentration.

Vitamins

Vitamin-A requirements of children is 600µg. Vitamin-C requirements are 40mg. Vitamin B complex requirements increase with calorie needs. The RDA of vitamins A and C are same as adult RDA.

Food Requirements

A natural increase in appetite is responsible for an increase in food consumption. Parents should encourage the child to eat appropriate portion sizes, eating a variety of food to meet their nutritional requirements.

Importance of breakfast

- Children who skip breakfast do not make up for the nutrition and energy needs and tend to perform poorly in academics(NIN, 2003-2004)
- Eating breakfast is a healthy habit.
- An ideal breakfast should have all 4 basic food groups.

Dietary Guidelines for School Children

- Nutritional requirements should meet their activity, growth and special requirements during sickness and injury.
- Menus should provide dishes that are quick to eat, nutritious and variety is needed.

Table 10 Balanced diet for School Going Children

		Quantity(g)		
		7-9 years	10-12 years	
Food groups	**g/portion**		**Boys**	**Girls**
Cereals and millets	30	6	8	10
Pulses	30	2	2	2
Milk (ml)	100	5	5	5
Roots and tubers	100	1	1	1
Green leafy vegetables	100	1	1	1
Other vegetables	100	1	2	2
Fruits	100	1	1	1
Sugar	5	4	6	6
Fats / Oils (visible)	5	6	7	7

Source: Dietary Guidelines for Indians - A manual, National Institute of Nutrition, ICMR, Hyderabad, India (2011)

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